you found that the pages were not in their correct order, the precise details of the page arrangement are something you'd probably care little about. If you've seen one disordered page arrangement, you've pretty much seen them all. Unless for some strange reason you get mired in the minutiae of which pages happen to appear here or there in the stack, you'd hardly notice if someone further jumbled an out-of-order page arrangement you'd initially been given. The initial stack would look disordered and the further jumbled stack would also look disordered. So not only is the statistical reasoning enormously easier to carry out, but the answer it yields— ordered versus disordered—is more relevant to our real concern, to the kind of thing of which we would typically take note.

This sort of big-picture thinking is central to the statistical basis of entropic reasoning. Just as any lottery ticket has the same chance of winning as any other, after many tosses of *War and Peace* any particular ordering of the pages is just as likely to occur as any other. What makes the statistical reasoning fly is our declaration that there are two *interesting classes* of page configurations: ordered and disordered. The first class has one member (the correct page ordering 1, 2; 3, 4; and so on) while the second class has a huge number of members (every other possible page ordering). These two classes are a sensible set to use since, as above, they capture the overall, gross assessment you'd make on thumbing through any given page arrangement.

Even so, you might suggest making finer distinctions between these two classes, such as arrangements with just a handful of pages out of order, arrangements with only pages in the first chapter out of order, and so on. In fact, it can sometimes be useful to consider these intermediate classes. However, the number of possible page arrangements in each of these new subclasses is still extremely small compared with the number in the fully disordered class. For example, the total number of out-of-order arrangements that involve only the pages in Part One of *War and Peace* is 10^{-178} of 1 percent of the total number of out-of-order arrangements involving all pages. So, although on the initial tosses of the unbound book the resulting page arrangement will likely belong to one of the intermediate, not fully disordered classes, it is almost certain that if you repeat the tossing action many times over, the page order will ultimately exhibit no obvious pattern whatsoever. The page arrangement